

Activity 3: Create a data validation rule and name a range

In this activity, you continue working with your spreadsheet from the previous activity. You name a range for the bakery products. You then use a data validation rule to ensure that everyone entering products into the spreadsheet uses the correct value. You then repeat the process for regions.

Complete the following steps:

Create a named range:

1. Select **E2:E289**, right-click, and select **View more cell actions > Define the named range**.
2. Type **Products** as the range name.
3. Experiment using the named range in an empty cell. For example, create a formula that uses the named range to find the average sales forecast.
Use `=AVERAGE(Products)`
4. Delete the formula from step 3 before proceeding to the next step.

Create a data validation rule:

5. Select **A2:G289**. From the **Data** menu, select **Data cleanup > Trim whitespace**, then click **OK**. (Before you create a data validation rule for the bakery products, you want to make sure that there are no leading trailing whitespace characters in the product column.)
6. Select any cell to clear the selection. Now, from the **Data** menu, select **Data validation**.
7. In the **Data validation rules** panel, click **+ Add rule**.
8. For the Cell range, use **C2:C289**.
9. For criteria, choose **Dropdown** and type in **Cinnamon bun** into the **Option 1** box and **Rye bread** for the **Option 2** box.
10. Click **Add another item**, and then type **Pastries** into the empty box, and then click **Done**.
11. Review the Products range as you note that there are some invalid entries in this range. Find all the instances of invalid data and correct them by choosing a selection from the drop-down list.
12. Create another data validation rule for regions. Are there any errors?

Do not close your Google Sheets spreadsheet. You use it in the next activity.